
LECTURE NOTES

Lecture 3: Social Cognition

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1 Our self

- Each situational norm engages different aspects of the self → steers the encoding and retrieval of our “self-knowledge” such as:
 - working self-concept
 - relational self-concept
 - personal self-concept
- This is also stored in schrema
- We have more differet selves
 - **Actual** or current self (that’s where the behaviour matters)
 - Ideal self, (who we want to be)
 - Ought self (what we think, who we should be)
 - Feared self (what we could become and don’t want too)

2 Needs and regulations

Need for accuracy:

- To make our future outcomes predictable, we need a fairly accurate assessment of our abilities, opinions, beliefs, and emotions

Need for consistency:

- To trust our accuracy judgements, we need to have a pretty consistent/ stable self-concept → we often seek situations that confirm how we see ourselves (e.g., procrastination to confirm that we are unable to solve a task)

Self-enhancement:

- We need to feel good about ourselves and maintain self-esteem → Source of a lot of

biases (e.g., we remember our good deeds better than our faults, perceive us as less biased, more competent and happier than others)

3 Social identity & self-categorization theory

- We all have a personal identity & several social identities
- Social identities emerge from our social roles, groups, and categories
- Depending on the context, different identities can be salient
- Salient identities shape our perceptions, emotions, and behaviours